MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FILTERS, PARTICULATE, HIGH-EFFICIENCY, FIRE RESISTANT, BIOLOGICAL USE, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by the US Army Armament Research and Development Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Department and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the general requirements for particulate filters for use in air cleaning or air filtering systems involving chemical, carcinogenic, radiogenic, or hazardous biological particulates. Additional requirements for specific filters are contained in applicable specification sheet.

1.2 Classification. The filters covered by this specification shall be designated in the following form as type, size, class, style, and rated airflow, and as specified in the applicable specification sheet and in 3.1 and 6.2.

	6			2 to 4
A	digits	a	o	digits
TYPE (see 1.2.1)	SIZE (see 1.2.2)	CLASS (see 1.2.3)	STYLE (see 1.2.4)	RATED AIRFLOW (see 1.2.5)

1.2.1 Type. Type of filter shall be designated by capital letter A through E as specified on the specification sheet.

1.2.2 Size. Size of filter shall be designated by height, length, and depth dimensions in integer numbers in inches of filter face as specified on the specification sheet.

: Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed: to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDAR-TSC-S, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21010 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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1.2.3 Class. Class of filter shall be designated as follows:

a - cold rolled steel frame (see 3.2.1.1 for class a)
b - stainless steel frame (see 3.2.1.1 for class b)
c - exterior plywood frame (see 3.2.1.1 for class c)
d - particle board (see 3.2.1.1 for class d)

1.2.4 Style. Style of filter shall be designated as follows:

0 - without separators
1 - with aluminum separators

1.2.5 Rated airflow. Rated airflow of filter shall be designated by a two, three, or four digit number expressing the rated airflow of the filter in cubic feet per minute (cfm).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications, standards, and handbooks of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-P-416 - Plating, Cadmium (Electrodeposited).
QQ-S-766 - Steel Plates, Sheets, and Strip - Corrosion Resisting.

MILITARY

MIL-F-51079 - Filter Medium, Fire-Resistant, High Efficiency.
MIL-A-81596 - Aluminum Foil for Sandwich Construction.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-282 - Filter Units, Protective Clothing, Gas-Mask Components and Related Products: Performance Test Methods.
MIL-STD-1188 - Commercial Packaging of Supplies and Equipment.

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DRAWINGS

US ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT COMMAND

CHEMICAL SYSTEMS LABORATORY

DLB76-2-639 - Penetrometer, Filter Testing, DOP, Q107.
DLB136-42-850 - Penetrometer, Filter Testing, DOP, Q76.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

ASTM STANDARDS

A268 - Standard Specification for Seamless and Welded Ferritic Stainless Steel Tubing for General Service.
A366 - Standard Specification for Steel, Carbon, Cold-Rolled Sheet, Commercial Quality.
D1056 - Standard Specification for Flexible Cellular Materials - Sponge or Expanded Rubber.
D1225 - Standard Test Method for Flat Crush of Corrugated Paperboard.
E84 - Standard Test Method for Surface Burning Characteristics of Building Materials.
A165 - Standard Specification for Electrodeposited Coatings of Cadmium on Steel.
A176 - Standard Specification for Stainless and Heat-Resisting Chromium Steel Plate, Sheet and Strip.

(Application for copies should be addressed to ASTM, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

ANSI STANDARDS

ANSI B132.1 - High Efficiency Air Filter Units.
ANSI PS1 - Construction and Industrial Plywood.

(Copies of these standards may be obtained from American National Standards Institute, 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

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US DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE

COMMERCIAL STANDARDS

CS236 - Mat-Formed Wood Particle Board.

(Copies of these standards may be obtained from the US Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of the specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual filter requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheets. In the event of any conflict between requirements of this specification and the specification sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Materials and components.

3.2.1 Frame.

3.2.1.1 Frame material. The frame shall be made from the material as specified for each of the following filter classes:

Class a - Cold-rolled steel sheet, 0.0747 inch (14 gage USS) minimum thickness conforming to ASTM A366. Prior to frame construction, the metal sections shall be cadmium plated in accordance with class 2, type II of QQ-P-416 or ASTM A165, type OS welded frame assemblies shall be plated after welding.

Class b - Stainless steel, 0.0747 inch (14 gage USS) minimum thickness, conforming to QQ-S-766 or ASTM A176 with the exception that the chemical requirements shall conform with ASTM A268 TP-409.

Class c - 3/4 inch plywood conforming to exterior type, grade A-B, Group 1, seven ply, solid core jointed of ANSI PS1, and fire retardant treated (see 3.2.1.2).

Class d - 3/4 inch wood particle board for exterior application with filler on both faces and conforming to type 2, grade B (with a minimum density of 45 pounds per cubic foot) class 2 of CS-236.

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3.2.1.2 Flame spread classification. The plywood frame shall have a flame spread classification of 25 or less when tested as specified in ASTM E84.

3.2.2 Gasket material. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), gasket material shall be oil resistant, expanded cellular rubber in accordance with grade SCE-43 or 44 of ASTM D1056.

3.2.3 Adhesives and sealants. Adhesives used to splice the medium, fasten gasket to filter face, and sealants or adhesives used to seal the filter pack to the frame shall be self-extinguishing type after direct contact with an open flame, as evidenced by testing in accordance with the spot-flame test of ANSI B132.1 (see 6.3).

3.2.4 Filter medium. The filter medium shall conform to MIL-F-51079.

3.2.5 Separators. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, filters of the style specified shall have their filter medium pleats spaced either without separators or with corrugated aluminum separators of material specified below (see 6.2).

Style 0 - without separators

Style 1 - with aluminum separators .0015 inch minimum thickness - separators shall be made of aluminum alloys 3003-H19, conforming to MIL-A-81596, and 5052-H39 conforming to the same specification with the exception of the temper. The corrugated aluminum separators shall have a resistance to compression of 10 pound-force per square inch (psi) when tested in accordance with para 4.4.4.4 (see 6.2).

3.3 Manufacture and assembly.

3.3.1 Construction. Unless otherwise specified in the contract (see 6.2), each type and size of filter shall be constructed to conform to the dimensions specified on the specification sheet for the applicable filter.

3.3.2 Flatness and squareness. The faces of the frame shall be flat and parallel to within a total allowance of 1/16 inch. The frame shall be square to within a total allowance of 1/8 inch when measured diagonally across the corner of both faces.

3.3.3 Gasket assembly. The gasket shall be fastened to the influent face of the filter frame, and shall be made from the material specified in 3.2.2 or in the contract. The gasket shall be 1/4 $\pm$ 1/32 inch thick by 3/4 $\pm$ 1/32 inch wide and flush with the outer edges of the frame. The gasket shall be either molded in continuous unbroken form, or made from four strips joined at the corners by interlocking construction with sealant, so that no gaps are visible and

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the joint shall be air tight. The gasket shall be continuously cemented to the face of the filter frame so as to prevent any air leakage between gasket and frame.

3.3.4 Medium installation. The filter medium shall be securely fastened to sides and ends of the filter frame with adhesive to completely seal edges of medium to filter frame. Adhesive material shall not extend into the filter pack medium more than 1/2 inch from the inside perimeter edge of frame.

3.3.4.1 Patching and splicing. Individual patching shall not be more than 2 square inches for any one patch nor collectively a total area of more than 2 percent of the face of the filter. When two pieces of media are joined by splicing, the pieces shall be overlapped at least 1-1/2 inches and the joined area shall be thoroughly coated with adhesive on each piece. Splices shall not be located at the folds of pleats.

3.3.5 Marking. Each filter shall be marked by stencilling or with a non-removable label on the top of the frame to indicate the manufacturer, model, serial number, test air flow direction, airflow resistance at rated airflow and the results of the dioctylphthalate (DOP) smoke penetration test at rated airflow or test flow and at 20 percent of rated airflow for all types and sizes of filters. In addition the wording "Install With This Side Up" shall be stencilled on the top of the frame in 3/8 inch minimum height letters. The top of the filter shall be perpendicular to the pleats in the filter medium.

3.4 Performance.

3.4.1 (DOP) penetration.

3.4.1.1 DOP penetration of filters with rated airflow. The total DOP smoke penetration through the filter medium, frame, and gasket of a filter which has been encapsulated, shall be no greater than 0.03 percent of upstream concentration at rated airflow or 1000 cfm where indicated and at 20 percent of rated airflow for all sizes when tested as specified in 4.4.4.1. Filters with rated flow greater than 1000 cfm shall be tested at 1000 cfm.

3.4.1.2 DOP scanning of entire filter. The DOP smoke penetration shall be no greater than 0.01 percent of the challenging concentration at an average air velocity of 90 $\pm$ 10 feet per minute (fpm) for all sizes when tested in accordance with 4.4.4.2.

3.4.2 Resistance to airflow. The resistance to airflow at the rated airflow of the filter shall be no greater than 1.0 inch (25.4 millimeters) of water for all sizes of filter when tested in accordance with 4.4.4.1.

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3.4.3 Resistance to vibration and impact. The filters shall be free from cracked or warped frames, loose corners or joints, cracked adhesives, and loose or deformed medium or separators, after vibrating in accordance with 4.4.4.3 for 15 minutes at 3/4 inch (19.1 mm) total amplitude and a frequency of 200 cycles per minute with faces, pleats, and separators in a vertical position (see specification sheet figure). Also, after vibrating the same filter shall meet the requirements in 3.4.1 and 3.4.2.

3.4.4 Resistance to heated air. The DOP smoke penetration through the filter medium, frame, and gasket, when tested at the rated airflow of the filter and in accordance with 4.4.4.1 shall not exceed 3.0 percent after heated air at rated airflow at a temperature of 700° ± 50°F (371° ± 27.8°C) has been passed through the filter (face of gasket and sides of filter not exposed) for no less than 5 minutes at the airflow rate for the size specified on the specification sheet and tested in accordance with 4.3.4.1.

3.4.5 Spot flame resistance. After the removal of the test flame at each point of application, there shall be no sustained flaming on the downstream face of the unit and there shall be no transmittal of flame to the outside surfaces of the frame, gaskets, separators, medium or adhesive when tested in accordance with 4.3.4.2.

3.5 Preproduction. Prior to the start of production, a preproduction sample of filters shall be produced in accordance with this specification for examination and test (see 4.3 and 6.2).

3.6 Workmanship. The filters shall be free from foreign matter (dirt, oil, or viscous material) and damage, such as distorted or cracked frames, deformation or sagging of medium and separators, cracks in adhesive and cracks and holes or any other damage in the exposed portions of the medium.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.

4.1.1 Contractor's responsibility. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.2 Government's responsibility. Unless otherwise specified, the Government will be responsible for the performance of the tests in 4.3. Samples will be forwarded to the laboratory designated by the contracting officer (6.2).

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4.1.3 Objective evidence. The contractor shall provide objective evidence acceptable to the contracting officer that the requirements of 3.3, and section 5 for which specific inspection has not been provided in the specification have been satisfied.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

(a) Preproduction inspection (see 4.3)
(b) Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 Preproduction inspection.

4.3.1 Sample. Prior to the start of regular production, a preproduction sample of five filters shall be manufactured using the same methods, equipment, and processes as will be used during regular production.

4.3.2 Examination. Each preproduction sample filter shall be examined for all the characteristics in the classification of defects (4.4.3.3).

4.3.3 For tests. The sample filters shall be tested for all the requirements of this specification in accordance with the groupings of filter, quantity and sequence of tests shown in table I. If the size of the sample filters exceed 24 inches in either their height or width, a 24 inch by 24 inch filter, certified as being of the same materials and manufactured process, may be substituted as test specimens for the heated air test. This is permitted where the heated air equipment will not accomodate large filters.

TABLE I. Test groups and sequence

Group Quantity Size	Test sequence Requirements	Test paragraph
Group - A	Resistance to airflow at rated airflow (3.4.2)	4.4.4.1
Quantity - 4 filters	DOP smoke penetration at rated or test airflow and at 20 percent of rated airflow (3.4.1.1)	4.4.4.1
	DOP scanning (3.4.1.2)	4.4.4.2
	Resistance to vibration and impact (3.4.3)	4.4.4.3
	Resistance to heated air (3.4.4)	4.3.4.1
Group - B	Resistance to spot flame (3.4.5)	4.3.4.2
Quantity - 1 filter		

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4.3.4 Tests.

4.3.4.1 Resistance to heated air. The resistance to heated air for filters shall be determined using a single pass air preheater capable of delivering air at rated airflow (see applicable specification sheet for rated airflow) and temperature as specified. In addition the temperature differential shall not vary as much as 10°F across the face of the filter at any one point. After the hot air chamber has reached 700° ± 50°F (371° ± 27.8°C), the filter shall be placed into the chamber, and when the chamber temperature recovers to 700°F ± 50°F (371° ± 27.8°C), the 5-minute exposure shall commence (see 6.4).

4.3.4.2 Resistance to spot flame. The resistance to spot flame shall be determined in accordance with the applicable test method in ANSI B132.1.

4.3.5 Acceptance/rejection criteria.

4.3.5.1 Preproduction examination and tests. Failure of any filter to comply with the requirements of this specification when examined as specified in 4.3.2 and tested as specified in 4.3.3 shall disqualify the entire sample.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Lotting. A lot shall consist of the completed filters of the same size produced by one manufacturer, at one plant, from the same materials, under essentially the same manufacturing conditions. However, no more than one lot of filter medium shall be represented in any one lot of finished filters.

4.4.2 Sampling for examination and tests. Sampling for examination and tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For major defect 101, resistance to vibration and impact, level S-4 shall be used.

4.4.3 Inspection procedures.

4.4.3.1 For examination and test. Sample filters shall be examined and tested in accordance with the classification of defects (4.4.3.3) and with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.3.2 For critical defects. Each filter in the lot shall be tested for its critical characteristics listed in the classification of defects.

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4.4.3.3 Classification of defects.

(a) Filter, particulate, high-efficiency, fire resistant, biological.

Categories	Defects	Acceptance standards
Critical:		
1	DOP smoke penetration (3.4.1.1)	4.4.4.1
2	DOP scanning (3.4.1.2)	4.4.4.2
3	Resistance to airflow (3.4.2)	4.4.4.1
Major:	AQL 1.5 percent defective	
101	Resistance to vibration and impact (3.4.3)	4.4.4.3
	AQL 1.0 percent defective	
102	Component incorrect, missing or incorrectly assembled (3.3.1)	
103	Dimensions not as specified (height, length, depth)	
104	Flatness incorrect (3.3.2)	
105	Medium installation (3.3.4)	
106	Frame not square within 1/8 inch on diagonal (across face) (3.3.2)	
107	Frame faces not parallel within 1/16 inch (3.3.2)	
108	Filter pack shows patches and splices not conforming to 3.3.4.1	
109	Gaskets not as specified (3.3.3)	
110	Workmanship (3.6)	
Minor:	AQL 2.5 percent defective	
201	Marking missing or illegible (3.3.5)	

(b) Packaging (section 5).

Categories	Defects
Critical:	None defined
Major:	AQL 4.0 percent defective
101	Marking missing, incorrect or illegible
102	Filter not oriented properly in box
103	Filter face not covered as specified

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4.4.4 Tests.

4.4.4.1 Resistance to airflow and DOP smoke penetration. The resistance to airflow and DOP smoke penetration of the filters shall be determined with the Q76 DOP Penetrometer (DLB 136-42-850) or the Q107 DOP Penetrometer (DLB 76-2-639), as applicable.

4.4.4.2 DOP scanning of filter. The DOP scanning shall be done by challenging the upstream side of the filter with a polydispersed DOP aerosol, then measuring and comparing (using linear or logarithmic photometers, calibrated and operated according to manufacturing instructions) the DOP concentration of sampled air taken from the influent and effluent side of the filter. During the test, the effluent side of the filter shall be scanned with a probe that is connected to the photometer, that is held at a maximum distance of 1 inch from the filter pack, and is moved across the filter pack in slightly overlapping strokes and around the perimeter of the filter pack at not more than 10 fpm. The maximum reading of the photometer during the scanning process is recorded. The location of the probe on the filter pack should be noted whenever the DOP reading exceeds 0.01 percent of the upstream concentration. The average air velocity of the test shall be 90 $\pm$ 10 fpm through the filter. The average air velocity of sampled air at the entrance of the probe shall be 100 + 10 or -0 fpm). The challenging DOP aerosol concentration shall be 100 $\pm$ 20 ug/l which is generated at room temperature with air and Laskin type nozzles. It shall consist of particles having a number mean diameter of 0.7 microns and the following particle size distribution:

99+ percent - less than 3.0 micron
95+ percent - less than 1.5 micron
92+ percent - less than 1.0 micron
50+ percent - less than 0.72 micron
25+ percent - less than 0.45 micron
10+ percent - less than 0.35 micron

It shall be well mixed with the influent air (homogeneous) at the influent sample port. The inlet diameter of the sample's probe shall be 1 inch diameter (approximately 0.01 square foot). The sample flow shall be 1 cfm $\pm$ 10 percent.

4.4.4.3 Resistance to vibration and impact. The filter shall be vibrated in accordance with test method T-105.10 of MIL-STD-282 and examined for damage and DOP penetration determined in accordance with 4.4.4.1. The filter alone shall be held firmly on the movable steel plate, resting on one side with its pleats and separators in a vertical position. The clamp(s) which hold the filter firmly to the plate should not distort the frame or body of the filter.

4.4.4.4 Resistance of separator to compression. Ten 4 inch by 4 inch specimens shall be sampled in accordance with ASTM D 1225. Specimens shall be cut by the use of a suitable cutter (see 6.5). The compression machine and the application of the compression load shall be in accordance with ASTM D 1225 with the provision that the horizontal movement of the test specimen shall be

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restricted. The compression load shall be applied at a rate of 25 ± 5 pound-force per second until the specimen completely collapses; the load is then noted as psi and compared to the minimum requirement of 10 psi (see 3.2.5).

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Commercial preservation, unit packing, and packing. Filters of the same type and size (see applicable specification sheet) shall be prepared for shipment in accordance with MIL-STD-1188. Filters shall be oriented so that the filter pleats are in vertical position.

5.2 Marking. In addition to any special markings required by the contract, marking shall be as specified herein.

5.2.1 Commercial packaging marking. Marking of commercial unit packing and packing (see 5.1) shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1188 and shall include the special marking of 5.2.2.

5.2.2 Special marking. The commercial unit containers (5.1) and shipping containers (5.2) shall be clearly marked with the following information:

(a) Mark on two adjacent sides the word "UP" with an arrow toward the top of the container to indicate vertical position of filter's pleats.
(b) "FRAGILE" and "HANDLE WITH CARE" labels or markings shall be applied to two adjacent sides of the box.

5.3 Palletization. When specified in the contract or order, filters, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be palletized in accordance with the appropriate load method of MIL-STD-147. Filters shall be crated when they are too large for standard palletization.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Filters are intended to be used in air cleaning equipment or air filtering and ventilating systems.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify:

(a) The title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Filter type (1.2.1 and applicable specification sheet).
(c) Filter size (1.2.2 and applicable specification sheet).
(d) Filter class (1.2.3).
(e) Filter style (1.2.4).
(f) Filter rated airflow (1.2.5).
(g) Gasket material, if other than specified in 3.2.2.
(h) Construction if other than specified in 3.3.1 and specification sheet.
(i) The laboratory to which samples are to be sent for testing (4.1.2).
(j) Separator required (3.2.5).

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(k) Separator material, if other than specified in 3.2.5.
(l) Quantity of packages per shipping container.
(m) Palletizing requirements (5.3).
(n) Preproduction:

(1) Time allowed for contractor submission of samples for Government test and evaluation after award of contract.
(2) Name and address of test facility and shipping instructions when testing is performed by the Government.
(3) Time required for the Government to notify the contractor whether to proceed with production.

6.3 Adhesives and sealants. Any adhesive or sealant found suitable during the preproduction tests will be acceptable.

6.4 Heated air tester. A suitable tester which is currently used consists of the following components connected in series in the order given: an air supply fan (type AH size 609 Berry Industrial Fan 1500 cfm measured at 700°F against 4" S.P. and at 2610 rpm), a gas fired air heater (700,000 Btu/hr), an air mixer (baffles and louvers), a test chamber, and an exhaust duct. Liquid propane gas (ca.2500 Btu/ft^3) is used as a fuel for the heater and the exhaust is vented to the outside. Both the airflow and the temperature controls are adjustable. The holding fixture for the test filter shall permit all the air to pass through the filter and shall prevent the air from passing over the face of the filter gasket and sides of the filter. This tester is available for inspection at Product Assurance Directorate, Chemicals Systems Division, DRDAR-QAC, Aberdeen Proving Ground, MD 21010.

CAUTION: Exhausts from this tester should be scrubbed and filtered before discharge to the atmosphere.

6.5 Compression resistance test. A satisfactory cutter for the preparation of the test specimen is the Elmendorf Sample Cutter 60-92 manufactured by Thining Albert Inst Co, 10960 Dutton Rd, Philadelphia, PA 19157.

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NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

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